

FROM AN ASSOCIATE DEGREE TO REAL MARKETING EXPERIENCE



MARKETING INTERNSHIP & CAREER LAUNCH

This plan is designed to help you turn what you learned while earning your associate degree into proof that you can do professional marketing work. By the end, you should have experience, portfolio pieces, resume bullets, and interview stories you can use to pursue your next opportunity.

FOR

START DATE

From DJ

A NOTE FROM ME

Why I Made This Plan for You

You have already done something important by earning your associate degree. This internship is the next step: a chance to take what you learned and show that you can apply it to a real business.

Because this is your first internship, I do not expect you to already know how professional marketing work is done. I do expect you to be curious, dependable, willing to ask questions, and open to feedback.

My goal is for you to finish with more than a line on your resume. I want you to have strong examples of your work, measurable results when possible, and clear stories you can tell employers about how you think and what you contributed.

DJ

WHAT YOU ALREADY BRING

An associate degree, fresh ideas, effort, and a willingness to learn. Those are real strengths.

WHAT WE ARE BUILDING

Professional experience, confidence, a portfolio, and evidence that you can contribute.

THE MAIN GOAL

When an employer asks what experience you have, you should be able to answer with specific projects, decisions, results, and lessons from this internship.

YOUR FIRST PROFESSIONAL ROLE

How to succeed when you have not interned before

Professional experience is mostly a set of habits. Nobody expects perfection, but people remember whether they can rely on you.

HABIT	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
Ask useful questions	Explain what you understand, then ask the specific question that will help you move forward.
Write things down	Keep notes from meetings, including decisions, deadlines, feedback, and your next steps.
Communicate early	If something may be late or unclear, say so before the deadline and suggest a solution.
Show work in progress	A useful draft gives us something to improve together.
Explain your reasoning	Be ready to explain the audience, goal, and choices behind the work.
Respond to feedback	Confirm what you heard, make the revision, and note what you learned.
Check the details	Proofread names, links, dates, facts, formatting, and filenames before handoff.
Close the loop	Say what is finished, where it is, and what you recommend next.

A SIMPLE UPDATE YOU CAN USE

I completed _____. I am working on _____. I need help with _____. The next step is _____.

QUALITY STANDARD

What finished should mean

A project is not finished only because the first draft exists. Use this checklist before handing off work.

CHECK	STANDARD
The goal is clear	I can explain who this is for, what it should accomplish, and why it matters.
The work is accurate	Names, facts, links, dates, spelling, and grammar have been checked.
The work is on-brand	The tone, logo, colors, and message fit DJ's House of Cards & Comics.
The work is usable	Files are clearly named, organized, and delivered in the right format.
The recommendation is clear	I explain what should happen next, not only what I observed.
The result is documented	I saved final work, feedback, and any results.
The lesson is captured	I wrote down what worked, what did not, and what I would improve.

A STRONG HANDOFF SOUNDS LIKE THIS

I completed the one-month social calendar. It includes audience, goal, caption, creative direction, and call to action for each post. I recommend starting with the Featured Find series because it is easiest to maintain and helps tell the story behind the inventory.

START WITH THESE

Five projects that can become strong job-application evidence

01	Brand and competitor audit
THE ASSIGNMENT	Compare our website and Facebook page with 5-10 similar businesses, then recommend what we should improve.
SKILLS YOU PRACTICE	Research, analysis, presentation, strategic recommendations
PROOF FOR EMPLOYERS	A polished audit that shows you can study a market and make decisions.
SUPPORT FROM ME	I will explain the business priorities and help you choose useful competitors.
02	Customer personas and journey review
THE ASSIGNMENT	Define the main audiences and test how easily each one can use the website.
SKILLS YOU PRACTICE	Audience strategy, customer experience, problem solving
PROOF FOR EMPLOYERS	Personas and a journey map that show customer-centered thinking.
SUPPORT FROM ME	I will answer questions about current customers and common inquiries.
03	Social content system
THE ASSIGNMENT	Build a one-month content calendar and create the first Featured Find posts.
SKILLS YOU PRACTICE	Content strategy, copywriting, organization, brand voice
PROOF FOR EMPLOYERS	A calendar and finished content samples you can place in a portfolio.
SUPPORT FROM ME	I will help choose products and review facts before anything is published.

BUILD THE STRONGEST EVIDENCE

Two projects that bring everything together

04	Buy, sell, and trade campaign
THE ASSIGNMENT	Create a clear campaign that encourages collection owners to contact the business.
SKILLS YOU PRACTICE	Campaign planning, lead generation, design direction, calls to action
PROOF FOR EMPLOYERS	A complete campaign that shows you can connect marketing to a business goal.
SUPPORT FROM ME	I will explain what collections I am interested in and review the offer.
05	Integrated capstone campaign
THE ASSIGNMENT	Plan, launch, measure, and present one focused marketing campaign.
SKILLS YOU PRACTICE	Strategy, project management, execution, analytics, presentation
PROOF FOR EMPLOYERS	A complete case study and your strongest interview story.
SUPPORT FROM ME	We will choose the theme together and review progress each week.

Career evidence tracker

SAVE THIS	WHY IT HELPS LATER
Original brief and goal	Shows you can connect work to a business problem.
Research, notes, and early drafts	Shows your process, judgment, and response to feedback.
Final approved work	Becomes the visual proof in your portfolio.
Results and feedback	Supports truthful resume bullets and interview answers.
Your reflection	Shows self-awareness and a willingness to improve.

PROJECT MENU

Research and strategy

Choose projects based on the skill you want to build and the portfolio proof you need.

PROJECT	WHAT YOU WILL DO	SKILLS	OUTPUT
Brand and competitor audit	Compare competitors and recommend improvements.	Research, analysis	Audit and recommendations
Customer personas	Create profiles for key customers.	Audience research	Customer profiles
SEO keyword research	Find search terms collectors use.	SEO, content planning	Keyword map
Marketing dashboard	Track useful marketing metrics.	Analytics, reporting	Monthly dashboard

HOW TO CHOOSE

Pick a project because it builds a skill you want, solves a business problem, or strengthens a gap in your portfolio. You do not need to complete every project.

PROJECT MENU

Content and storytelling

Choose projects based on the skill you want to build and the portfolio proof you need.

PROJECT	WHAT YOU WILL DO	SKILLS	OUTPUT
Social media calendar	Plan a month of posts.	Content strategy	Four-week calendar
Featured Find series	Tell the story behind selected items.	Copywriting	Four finished posts
Collector articles	Write helpful collector education content.	Writing, SEO	Three articles
Newsletter plan	Create a reason for people to return.	Email marketing	Template and samples

HOW TO CHOOSE

Pick a project because it builds a skill you want, solves a business problem, or strengthens a gap in your portfolio. You do not need to complete every project.

PROJECT MENU

Growth and outreach

Choose projects based on the skill you want to build and the portfolio proof you need.

PROJECT	WHAT YOU WILL DO	SKILLS	OUTPUT
Buy, sell, and trade campaign	Invite collection owners to contact the business.	Lead generation	Campaign assets
Partnership research	Find groups, shows, and businesses worth contacting.	Outreach	Ranked list
Customer survey	Ask collectors what they want.	Survey design	Findings report
Integrated campaign	Plan, launch, and review a full campaign.	Strategy, analytics	Case study

HOW TO CHOOSE

Pick a project because it builds a skill you want, solves a business problem, or strengthens a gap in your portfolio. You do not need to complete every project.

A SUPPORTED PROGRESSION

How I picture the eight weeks

WK	STAGE	MAIN WORK	HABIT	HANDOFF
1	Observe	Learn the business, customers, website, and tools.	Ask questions and take notes.	Initial observations
2	Research	Complete competitor research and personas.	Follow a brief.	Audit and personas
3	Assist	Draft the content plan.	Share early drafts.	Content calendar
4	Own	Complete SEO or conversion research.	Manage check-ins.	Recommendation report
5	Build	Create the buy, sell, and trade campaign.	Explain decisions.	Campaign assets
6	Launch	Publish approved work and begin measuring.	Communicate issues.	Live campaign
7	Analyze	Review results and improve the campaign.	Use evidence.	Results summary
8	Present	Complete portfolio and career materials.	Tell the story.	Final presentation

THE GOAL IS GROWTH, NOT PRETENDING

If you do not know something, ask. If you make a mistake, own it and correct it. Those are professional strengths, especially in a first internship.

USE BEFORE EVERY MAJOR ASSIGNMENT

Project brief and weekly check-in

PROJECT AND DEADLINE*What are you creating, and when are the draft and final due?***BUSINESS PROBLEM***What problem or opportunity are we working on?***AUDIENCE AND GOAL***Who is this for, and what should they think, feel, or do?***DELIVERABLE AND SUCCESS MEASURE***What will you hand me, and how will we know whether it worked?***QUESTIONS AND SUPPORT NEEDED***What do you need from me before you can move forward?*

TURN WORK INTO CAREER EVIDENCE

How to build a portfolio case study

STEP	WHAT TO SHOW
Context	Explain the business, audience, and situation.
Problem	State the challenge or opportunity.
Your role	Be honest about what you owned and what support you received.
Process	Show research, decisions, drafts, feedback, and revisions.
Final work	Include the strongest visuals or excerpts.
Result	Use numbers when available or explain the decision created.
Reflection	Explain what you learned and what you would improve.

EXAMPLE CASE-STUDY OPENING

DJ's House of Cards & Comics needed a more consistent way to share products and collector knowledge on social media. I researched comparable businesses, created a four-week content strategy, and developed a repeatable Featured Find series designed to increase engagement and product interest.

USE THE EXPERIENCE IN APPLICATIONS

Resume and LinkedIn builder

ACTION + WORK + PURPOSE + RESULT

Start with a strong verb, describe what you created or improved, explain the business purpose, and include a truthful result when one is available.

Bullet templates to complete with your real details

Researched [number] competitors and presented [number] recommendations to improve [website, content, or customer experience].

Developed a [length]-week social media calendar featuring [content types] to support [engagement, awareness, or sales goal].

Created a customer-focused campaign for [audience] using [assets/channels], resulting in [truthful result or business decision].

Analyzed [website, campaign, survey, or performance data] and recommended [specific improvements] based on the findings.

Wrote and edited [number] pieces of content about [topic], applying brand voice, audience research, and SEO principles.

Built a recurring marketing dashboard to track [metrics] and support monthly performance reviews.

LINKEDIN EXPERIENCE DESCRIPTION

Marketing Intern | DJ's House of Cards & Comics

Supported a growing sports-card, comics, and collectibles business through customer research, content planning, campaign development, website analysis, and performance reporting.

PREPARE TO TALK ABOUT THE WORK

Interview story builder

STAR PART	WHAT TO PREPARE
Situation	What was happening, and why did it matter?
Task	What were you responsible for doing?
Action	What steps and decisions did you personally make?
Result	What changed, what feedback did you receive, or what did you learn?

Stories to prepare before applying

INTERVIEW STORY	PROJECT I WILL USE	READY?
A project where you used research to make a recommendation.		
A time feedback caused you to improve your first draft.		
A time you had to learn a new tool, topic, or process.		
A campaign or piece of content you are proud of.		
A result that did not go as planned and what you learned.		

USE THIS AS A BRIDGE TO THE NEXT ROLE

Job-search plan

ROLE	WHY THIS INTERNSHIP HELPS
Marketing coordinator or assistant	Campaign support, calendars, reporting, and project organization.
Social media coordinator	Content planning, copywriting, publishing, and engagement review.
Content or communications assistant	Writing, editing, research, and brand voice.
Digital marketing assistant	SEO, email, campaign support, website review, and analytics.
E-commerce marketing assistant	Product storytelling, promotions, customer journey, and conversion thinking.
Community or partnership coordinator	Outreach, events, relationship building, and communication.

A REALISTIC TARGET

Start with roles where you meet many of the requirements, tailor the resume, include relevant work samples, and follow up professionally.

AT THE END OF THE INTERNSHIP

What I want you to leave with

AREA	WHAT WE WILL REVIEW	START	FINISH
Professional habits	Communication, reliability, organization, and response to feedback		
Strategic thinking	Understanding the audience, goal, business problem, and recommendation		
Execution quality	Accuracy, polish, brand consistency, and usefulness		
Marketing skills	Research, writing, content, campaigns, analytics, and presentation		
Independence	Ability to plan work, make decisions, and identify next steps		
Career readiness	Portfolio, resume, interview stories, and confidence explaining the work		

Questions I want us to talk through

What project best shows what you can contribute to a future employer?

What professional habit improved the most?

What feedback changed the way you work?

Which type of marketing work do you want to pursue next?

What is the strongest story you will tell in an interview?

WHAT I HOPE THIS BECOMES

A first professional experience that gives you the confidence and evidence to apply for opportunities that once felt out of reach.